two final deliveries. Could Boult play the Stokes role for New Zealand, and haul his team over the line, almost single-handedly? The jury was still out when he conceded 15 runs in his super over.

Though Chris Woakes was a viable alternative, Jofra Archer was the most obvious choice to bear the burden. It was another reminder of how professional cricket has changed during the course of my career. When I started, it was all about Test cricket. Jofra has learned his skill primarily in the shorter form of the game. He has made himself a world-class death bowler, under the contrasting pressure of being a high-profile franchise player.

No matter the colour of the ball, margins are extremely fine at the highest level. I didn't think the offside wide should have been called from Archer's opening delivery, but he refused to be flustered even when Jimmy Neesham hit him over midwicket, in the general direction of Regent's Park, for six. Two to win off the final ball, and everything was in slow motion.

Martin Guptill hit the ball to midwicket. Jason Roy swooped, collected and threw. Buttler broke the stumps with a split-second to spare. The bubble burst and suddenly there were bodies everywhere. It was only later that evening that I felt able to reflect on the bigger picture, and my hope that an aspiring professional cricketer would be out there thinking, 'I'll have some of that. I want to test myself. I will work harder.'

This was a team's moment in time. It is quite possible that that winning eleven will never play together again. Sport moves on, advances at pace. I was in the privileged position of knowing what it meant to the individuals involved. Though the triumph was collective, examples of personal achievement were compelling.

Liam Plunkett made his Test debut in Pakistan in 2005, when I was a prospect, in the squad, accumulating experience. He had his problems, leaving Durham for Yorkshire, and totally reinvented himself, from an aggressive seamer who sprayed it a bit, to a must-pick middle-over bowler, capable of consistent accuracy under pressure.

Aware that his place in the squad was being challenged, he evolved again in the build-up to the tournament. He developed versatility and subtlety, working on the slower, back-of-a-length delivery and the slower ball bouncer. By redefining himself, he proved himself as a player and person. Professional sport can be a cold place, but when such a genuinely good guy does well it is a cause for celebration.